

Five questions this dissertation opens. Each is the start of work that someone, someday, will do.

A PhD is a beginning, not an end.

Exp B	Does a much smaller reservoir suffice? The Takens margin is $16\text{--}64\times$. The reservoir is far larger than the data requires. A minimal-N study ($N = 64$, post-PCA = 16, or smaller) would test whether the dissertation's reservoir is over-provisioned for its actual measurement task. <i>Follow-up: minimal-N ablation.</i>
Exp C	Can the Propagation Operating Characteristic be derived analytically? The MC vs β curve was measured empirically. For known reservoir families (LIFReservoir at target ρ, sparse-Gaussian at given σ and density), does the MC peak position admit a closed-form expression? This is a tractable analytical follow-up question. <i>Open theoretical question.</i>
Exp D	Does the channel-permutation finding replicate on an independent clinical cohort? The methodology survives the strictest spatial null at the stimulus-class level. The per-disorder version (SUD, PTSD, GAD, ADHD) awaits an independent replication cohort. The dissertation does not yet have one. <i>Pending external data.</i>
Framework	Does the Measurement-Instrument Paradigm generalize to MEG and fMRI? The reservoir was treated as a measurement instrument with characterized ρ, λ_1, MC, m^*. Other neuroimaging modalities have different noise structures and timescales. Whether the paradigm transfers — and what it predicts in those modalities — is an open architectural question. <i>Cross-modality validation study.</i>
POC	Is there a single theoretical object that unifies driven contraction (λ_1) and memory capacity (MC)? The Propagation Operating Characteristic frames these as related, but treats them as two independent measurements. Whether they are two faces of one analytical object — say, a Lyapunov-weighted memory functional — is an open theoretical question the dissertation poses but cannot answer. <i>Open theoretical question.</i>

"This dissertation answers the questions it asks; it also opens five it cannot answer. Asking better questions than I can answer is what a doctorate of philosophy is for."